

YEAR 9 · THEME 1 · SCHOOL LIFE

Reading

B1.1

My New Pen Pal from Poland · International Day at Our School

9. Sınıf

Name – Surname

Class

No

Date

Aim Understand the main idea and details, make inferences and connect the text to your own life.

1 Before you read

Make predictions before you read.

1. Look at the title. What do you think this blog post is about?

2. Guess: what three things might Elif ask her new pen pal about?

My New Pen Pal from Poland

- 1 Hi, everyone! My name is Elif, and I'm a student at a school in Balıkesir, Türkiye. This month, our class started an international pen-pal project, and I'm so excited — my pen pal is Kasia, and she's from Poland!
- 2 Kasia is Polish, and she is from Warsaw, the capital city of Poland. In her first email, she told me that Warsaw's official language is Polish, but she can also speak good English and a little German. I told her that I am Turkish, and my nearest big city is İzmir.
- 3 Kasia says that in Warsaw, you can visit the Old Town, with its colourful buildings and the famous Royal Castle. You can also see a huge monument called the Palace of Culture and Science from almost anywhere in the city! She sent me a photo of the castle — it looks amazing.
- 4 I wrote back and told her about my own country. I explained that Ankara is the capital of Türkiye, but I live near İstanbul, where you can visit incredible mosques, palaces and the famous Grand Bazaar. I also told her about our national day, the 29th of October, when we celebrate the founding of the Turkish Republic.
- 5 Kasia and I are already planning to be video-call friends. We aren't in the same country, but with a pen pal like Kasia, the world feels a little smaller — and a lot more interesting!

234 words

2 While you read

6 × 2 pts

Circle the correct option.

1. What is the text mainly about?
☐ a A trip to Poland ☐ b Elif's new international pen pal ☐ c How to learn Polish
2. What is Kasia's nationality?
☐ a Turkish ☐ b Hungarian ☐ c Polish
3. What is the capital city of Poland?
☐ a Warsaw ☐ b Kraków ☐ c Gdańsk
4. According to the text, what can you visit in Warsaw?
☐ a The Grand Bazaar ☐ b The Old Town and the Royal Castle ☐ c The Flame Towers
5. Elif and Kasia are from the same country. ☐ Correct ☐ Incorrect

6. Why does Elif say the world feels 'a little smaller'?
☐ a Because she is moving to Poland ☐ b Because having a pen pal connects her to another country
☐ c Because Poland and Türkiye are very close

3 After you read*Write short answers. Then compare with a partner.*

1. If you had a pen pal from another country, what would you tell them about your country first? Write two sentences.

2. Compare Elif's city with Kasia's city. Find one similarity and one difference.

1 Before you read*Make predictions before you read.*

1. What do you think happens on an 'International Day' at a school?

2. Guess two things students might do to celebrate other countries at school.

International Day at Our School

- 1 Every spring, our school celebrates International Day, and it's one of my favourite events of the year. Students from different classes prepare a small stand about a country — its flag, capital city,

nationality, and one famous tourist attraction.

- 2 This year, my group chose Azerbaijan. We learned that the capital of Azerbaijan is Baku, and that Azerbaijani is the official language there. We found out that in Baku, you can see the famous Flame Towers, which light up in different colours at night. We also made a poster with the flag and some facts about the population.
- 3 Other groups presented Hungary and Poland. The Hungarian group explained that Budapest is the capital of Hungary, and that you can go sightseeing along the Danube River. The Polish group talked about Warsaw's Old Town and even brought a small national dish to try — everyone loved it!
- 4 In the afternoon, each group gave a short presentation about their country. We answered questions like 'Can you tell us about a national day in this country?' and 'What can tourists do there?' It was a great chance to practise speaking and to learn about the world at the same time.
- 5 At the end of the day, our teacher said that International Day helps us understand that although we come from different countries and speak different languages, we can still learn from each other and be good friends.

233 words

2 While you read

6 × 2 pts

Circle the correct option.

1. What is International Day at this school?
☐ a A sports competition ☐ b A day when students present facts about different countries
☐ c A national exam
 2. What is the capital of Azerbaijan?
☐ a Baku ☐ b Warsaw ☐ c Budapest
 3. What can tourists see in Baku, according to the text?
☐ a The Royal Castle ☐ b The Flame Towers ☐ c The Grand Bazaar
 4. What did the Hungarian group say you can do in Budapest?
☐ a Go sightseeing along the Danube River ☐ b Visit a famous castle ☐ c Try a national dish
 5. Each group only made a poster and did not speak to the class. ☐ Correct ☐ Incorrect
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6. What does the teacher's final comment suggest?
☐ a Learning about other countries can build friendship and understanding
☐ b International Day is not very useful ☐ c Students should only study their own country

3 After you read

Write short answers. Then compare with a partner.

1. If your school had an International Day, which country would you choose to present? Why?

2. Write two sentences about what tourists can do in your own country or city.
